Water Care

THE WATER CHALLENGE · TRACK A2 · LAYER 1: ORGANIZATION

Organizational Profile & Eligibility Passport

Everything a prospecting tool needs to decide whether a funder fits Water Care Canada, and whether the opportunity is worth two fundraisers' time.

2026-10-19	Q3 FY2026-27	v2.0
As-of date for all judgments	Capacity quarter	Pack version

> **Water Care is a fictional organization** created for the AI Hackathon 2026. Its strategy, finances, people, funders and history are invented. It is shaped like a Canadian international water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) charity so that real Canadian funder rules apply to it, but no figure in this pack describes WaterAid Canada or any real organization. Do not publish this material as fact.

Water Care Canada at a glance

Member of Water Care International, a fictional alliance that runs country programs; Water Care Canada raises and grants funds to them.

$5.4M	24	2	4 + 2	22 yrs
Revenue, FY2025-26	Staff in Canada (FTE)	Institutional fundraisers	Priority + secondary countries	Registered charity since 2004

VISION

Communities that can count on water, toilets and hygiene services long after any project ends.

MISSION

Make safe water, sanitation and hygiene permanent: services that last, systems that hold, and women and girls leading the decisions.

AMBITION

1.5 million people with lasting water, sanitation and hygiene services in Water Care focus districts by 2033.

VALUES

- **Durability.** We judge success by what still works in ten years.
- **Local leadership.** District governments and local partners lead; we strengthen.
- **Candour.** We report what failed as clearly as what worked.
- **Thrift.** Every dollar and every staff hour goes where it changes most.

STRATEGY 2023-2033: BUILT TO LAST: THREE GOALS

G1

Services that last

District water, sanitation and hygiene systems that keep working: local government and utilities, health facilities, and climate-resilient water sources.

- Health-facility WASH in every focus district
- Climate-risk assessment in every project design

G2

Women and girls decide

Gender-transformative programming: women in leadership roles on water committees and in utilities; menstrual health in schools and clinics.

- Women hold at least 40% of water-committee leadership roles
- Partnerships with women's rights organizations

G3

Canada invests

More and better Canadian money for lasting WASH: institutional fundraising, public engagement, and policy work with the Government of Canada.

- Foundations from 14% to 20% of income by FY2029-30
- Multi-year and unrestricted funding prioritized

TWO LENSES EVERY PROJECT MUST PASS

Gender-transformative
Every project must show how it shifts decision-making power toward women and girls.

Climate-resilient
Every project must show how services will survive floods, droughts and rising demand.

Where we work

Programs are delivered through Water Care International country programs and local partners. Water Care has no programs in Canada.

Country	Tier	Region	Focus	Since
Malawi	Priority	Sub-Saharan Africa (Southern)	3 focus districts; health-facility WASH, menstrual health in schools	2008
Mozambique	Priority	Sub-Saharan Africa (Southern)	2 focus districts in Inhambane Province; climate-resilient rural water after cyclone damage	2011
Ethiopia	Priority	Sub-Saharan Africa (East)	2 focus woredas; drought-resilient water supply, small-town utilities	2010
Nepal	Priority	South Asia	2 focus municipalities; spring-source protection, WASH in birthing centres	2014
Zambia	Secondary	Sub-Saharan Africa (Southern)	Federation program; Water Care Canada co-funds only, no Canadian-led projects	2019
Bangladesh	Secondary	South Asia	Federation program; climate-vulnerable coastal areas; co-funding only	2020

CORE THEMES (HIGHEST FIT)

WASH-HCF
WASH in healthcare facilities
Water, sanitation, hygiene, cleaning and waste services in clinics and birthing centres; maternal and newborn health.

WASH-CLIM
Climate-resilient water services
Climate-risk assessment, drought/flood-resilient sources, water-security planning, adaptation finance.

WASH-GEN
Gender-transformative WASH
Women's leadership, menstrual health, safety and dignity in sanitation.

WASH-SYS
District WASH systems strengthening
Local government, utilities, service-delivery models, monitoring, O&M financing.

SECONDARY THEMES

- **WASH-SCH** WASH in schools
- **WASH-HYG** Hygiene behaviour change
- **WASH-SAN** Sanitation services
- **POL-CAN** Canadian policy and advocacy
- **ENG-CAN** Canadian public engagement

POPULATIONS

- Women and girls
- People with disabilities
- Rural and peri-urban low-income communities
- Healthcare workers and patients (maternal and newborn care)
- School-age children

WE DO NOT DO

EX-HUM **Acute humanitarian / emergency first response.** Water Care does not run emergency response; recovery-phase work only, through federation programs.

EX-DOM **Domestic Canadian programs (including First Nations drinking water).** No programs in Canada. Canadian activity is limited to engagement and policy work.

EX-CAP **Capital-only infrastructure without an O&M plan.** Water Care will not build what no one is funded to maintain.

EX-IND **Grants or scholarships to individuals.** Not part of the delivery model.

EX-RES **Stand-alone academic research.** Only as an implementing partner on applied research.

Eligibility passport

The attributes funders screen on. Extract each funder's requirements into the same fields, then compare field by field. Cite the ID.

ID	Attribute	Water Care value	How to match
EP-01	Legal status	Registered charity (Canada)	Funder must accept registered charities.
EP-02	Qualified donee	Yes	Private and public foundations in Canada can generally grant only to qualified donees. Passes this gate.
EP-03	CRA designation	Charitable organization	Some funders exclude public/private foundations as applicants. Water Care is not a foundation.
EP-04	Charitable registration #	000000000 RR0001 (SYNTHETIC)	Placeholder only. Never treat as real.
EP-05	Incorporation	Federal, Canada Not-for-profit Corporations Act, 2003	Federal incorporation satisfies 'Canadian-incorporated' requirements.
EP-06	Years registered	22 (since 2004)	Passes minimum operating-history rules up to 22 years.
EP-07	Head office	Toronto, Ontario	Passes Ontario- and GTA-restricted funders ONLY when the funder allows international beneficiaries.
EP-08	Provinces with staff	Ontario (22 FTE), British Columbia (2 FTE remote)	No Quebec presence. Fails funders requiring a Quebec office.
EP-09	Annual revenue (FY2025-26)	$5,400,000 CAD	Fails revenue caps below $5.4M (e.g., 'organizations under $2M').
EP-10	Audited financial statements	Yes, last 3 years	Passes audit requirements.
EP-11	Fiscal year end	March 31	Align reporting cycles.
EP-12	Delivery model	International programs delivered through Water Care International country programs and local partners, via grant agreements with accountability measures (qualifying disbursements) or direct-and-control arrangements	Fails funders that fund only local in-country CSOs directly. Passes funders that fund Canadian charities working internationally.
EP-13	Programs in Canada	No (engagement and policy only)	Fails 'Canadian beneficiaries only' funders.
EP-14	Priority countries	Malawi, Mozambique, Ethiopia, Nepal	Geographic match: strongest.
EP-15	Secondary countries	Zambia, Bangladesh (co-funding only)	Geographic match: partial; cannot lead.
EP-16	Regions	Southern Africa, East Africa, South Asia	Fails region-restricted funders outside these (e.g., West Africa only, Latin America).
EP-17	Core themes	WASH-HCF, WASH-CLIM, WASH-GEN, WASH-SYS	Highest fit.
EP-18	Secondary themes	WASH-SCH, WASH-HYG, WASH-SAN, POL-CAN, ENG-CAN	Moderate fit.
EP-19	Will not do	Emergency first response; domestic Canadian programs; capital-only works; grants to individuals; stand-alone research	Hard decline.

ID	Attribute	Water Care value	How to match
EP-20	Populations	Women and girls; People with disabilities; Rural and peri-urban low-income communities; Healthcare workers and patients (maternal and newborn care); School-age children	Match to funder population focus.
EP-21	SDGs	Primary SDG 6; secondary SDG 3, 5, 13	Match to funder SDG framing.
EP-22	Application languages	English: full capacity. French: summaries only (1 staff member)	Fails funders requiring full French applications.
EP-23	Indigenous-led organization	No	Fails Indigenous-led-only funders.
EP-24	Women-led organization	CEO is a woman; 7 of 12 directors are women; Board Chair is a man	AMBIGUOUS: passes 'woman CEO' or 'majority-women board' definitions; fails 'woman Board Chair' or '75%+ women' definitions. Flag for human review.
EP-25	Policies in place	Safeguarding; gender equality; anti-fraud and corruption; sanctions/anti-terrorism screening; environmental and social safeguards; privacy; whistleblower	Passes standard due-diligence checklists.
EP-26	Minimum viable grant	$15,000 CAD	Below this, decline unless a strategic relationship justifies it.
EP-27	Grant sweet spot	$50,000-$500,000 CAD per year	Best yield per hour of effort.
EP-28	Max new restricted funding per year	$2,500,000 CAD	Program absorptive capacity; larger awards need a consortium.
EP-29	Cash match capacity	Up to 20% of project value from unrestricted funds	Fails 1:1 match requirements unless a co-funder is secured.
EP-30	Standard indirect cost rate	12%	Funders capping indirect costs below 10% reduce net value (soft penalty, not a gate).
EP-31	Accepts multi-year funding	Yes (preferred)	Positive signal.
EP-32	Reporting capacity	Quarterly or semi-annual narrative + financial is standard; monthly reporting is high burden	Soft penalty for monthly reporting.
EP-33	Gift acceptance: excluded sources	Tobacco; weapons; gambling; companies with active WASH-related human-rights litigation	Hard decline.
EP-34	Gift acceptance: CEO review required	Bottled water and beverage companies; extractives (mining, oil and gas); agro-chemicals	Route to REVIEW, never auto-pursue.
EP-35	US tax status	None (no US 501(c)(3) affiliate; no equivalency determination on file)	US private foundations need an equivalency determination or expenditure responsibility. Flag as uncertain.
EP-36	Federal international assistance track record	2 completed federal contribution agreements since 2018	Positive signal for government calls.

GIFT ACCEPTANCE

Excluded sources (hard decline)

- Tobacco
- Weapons and arms
- Gambling
- Companies with active WASH-related human-rights litigation

CEO review required (route to REVIEW)

- Bottled water and beverage companies
- Extractives: mining, oil and gas
- Agro-chemicals

How Water Care decides what to pursue

Gates first, then weighted fit, then capacity. With two fundraisers, the binding constraint is proposal hours, not discovery.

STAGE 1: HARD GATES

Gate	Test
G1 Legal eligibility	Funder accepts registered Canadian charities / qualified donees (EP-01, EP-02, EP-03, EP-35).
G2 Beneficiary geography	International work allowed AND at least one Water Care country or region eligible (EP-13 to EP-16).
G3 Thematic eligibility	WASH or a core-adjacent theme (health, climate, gender) is fundable; not an excluded theme (EP-17 to EP-19).
G4 Organizational restrictions	Revenue caps, Indigenous-led, women-led, grassroots, provincial presence, language (EP-08, EP-09, EP-22 to EP-24).
G5 Gift acceptance	Source is not excluded; review-category sources route to REVIEW (EP-33, EP-34).
G6 Access	Open call, LOI, rolling, or invitation with a credible relationship path.
G7 Timeline feasibility	Days to deadline at or above the minimum preparation days for the application type, with hours available.
G8 Financial terms	Match requirement within 20% capacity, or a co-funder identified (EP-29).

STAGE 2: WEIGHTED FIT (0-5). PURSUE AT 3.5 OR ABOVE; MONITOR 2.8-3.49; DECLINE BELOW 2.8

Criterion	Weight	Scoring anchors (0-5)
C1 Strategic alignment	25%	5 = core theme is the funder's stated priority; 3 = secondary theme or WASH as an eligible activity under health/climate/gender; 1 = loose link.
C2 Geographic alignment	15%	5 = priority country named; 4 = region-open including a priority country; 3 = global; 2 = secondary country only.
C3 Economic yield	20%	Expected value per fundraising hour (Capacity_Model, includes LOI follow-on effort): 5 = above $3,000; 4 = $1,500-3,000; 3 = $750-1,500; 2 = $300-750; 1 = below $300.
C4 Relationship strength	15%	5 = active funder; 4 = warm (board or staff connection with consent); 3 = lapsed in good standing; 2 = cold; 1 = lapsed with issues.
C5 Win signals	10%	5 = funds peer international WASH charities; 3 = funds international development generally; 1 = no international giving history.
C6 Timeline & burden	10%	5 = comfortable timeline, light reporting; 3 = tight or quarterly reporting; 1 = monthly reporting or very tight.
C7 Strategic value	5%	5 = multi-year, unrestricted or policy access; 3 = standard restricted; 1 = restricted and one-off.

STAGE 3: CAPACITY, Q3 FY2026-27 (OCT 1 - DEC 31, 2026)

330 hrs
New-business hours available

285 hrs
Already committed

45 hrs
Remaining this quarter

EFFORT BY APPLICATION TYPE

Application type	Fundraising hrs	Program hrs	Min. prep days
LOI	8	0	7
Short application	24	6	14
Full proposal	60	20	30
Corporate proposal	40	8	21
Government call	220	80	45
Renewal	30	8	21

Blended fundraising cost about $63/hr; program input $65/hr. Minimum viable grant $15,000. Historical success rates and the expected-value calculator are in the workbook (L1_Capacity_Model, L1_Win_Rates).

DECISIONS

Decision	Meaning
PURSUE	Eligible, fit score at or above 3.5, and capacity available this quarter.
PURSUE-QUEUE	Eligible with strong fit, but this quarter's capacity is used up; schedule for next window.
CULTIVATE	Not applicable now (invitation-only, relationship needs repair, no open call) but worth building toward.
REVIEW	A human decision is required: gift acceptance, ambiguous eligibility, or conflicting/unverified facts.
MONITOR	Eligible but moderate fit (2.8-3.49) or no confirmed deadline; recheck next cycle.
DECLINE	Fails a hard gate or fit score below 2.8.

REVENUE MIX, FY2025-26 ($5.4M)



- Individual giving **$2.48M**
- Government (federal international assistance) **$1.46M**
- Foundations **$0.76M**
- Corporate **$0.43M**
- Other (events, investment) **$0.27M**

Spending: programs 78%, fundraising 14%, administration 8%. Clean audits FY2023-24 to FY2025-26. Standard indirect cost rate 12%. Strategy target: foundations from 14% to 20% of income by FY2029-30.

> **What 'good' looks like.** A recommendation names the decision, the gate or criterion that drove it (by ID), the evidence with its source and date, and anything uncertain. It never invents a deadline, amount or eligibility rule. When the evidence does not settle eligibility, the right answer is REVIEW.